

Footage Renamer

User guide for creative strategists. How to turn a creator's raw, messy uploads into clean, storyboard ready footage automatically.

What this tool does

The Footage Renamer takes the raw clips a content creator uploads to Dropbox and renames them to match your storyboard. It watches every clip, works out which shot it is, gives it the correct name, and saves a clean copy inside the same client folder. You never rename a single file by hand.

What you need before you start

1. A **storyboard** for the concept, written as a **table** in the Notion page. Columns: Scene, Script Line, Overlay, Footage Name, Shot List Explanation.
2. A **Dropbox upload folder** for that batch (the same folder you share with the creator). Once the creator finishes uploading, the raw clips live in that folder.

How to run a job

- 1 **Make sure the footage is uploaded.** The creator drops their raw clips into the batch folder you gave them, inside the client folder.
- 2 **Open the File Renaming Automation database in Notion** and create a row for the concept (or use the one you prepared).
- 3 **Fill the row.** Client's Name (names the folder), Creator Name (for example, Ashley), Dropbox Upload Link (paste the link to the batch folder where the raw clips live), and paste the storyboard table into the page under STORYBOARD HERE.
- 4 **Click the READY button.** That sets the row to Queued.
- 5 **Wait about two minutes.** The tool runs on its own and updates the row for you (see below).

What you get back

Inside the same upload folder, the tool creates a subfolder called `renamed`. Inside it you find:

- `roll` : the clips, renamed to match your storyboard.
- `_report.md` : a short report of what was renamed, what was missing, and anything to check.

The original raw files are never touched. They stay exactly where the creator put them. The renamed copies sit right beside them in the `renamed` folder, and the Notion row gets a link to it.

The row updates itself

When the job finishes, these three fields fill in automatically:

Field	What it shows
Status	<code>Needs review</code> or <code>Done</code>
Output Folder	A link to the <code>renamed</code> folder so the team can grab the files.
Comment	The full report, posted right on the row.

Status meanings

Status	Meaning
Queued	You clicked READY. The tool picks it up within two minutes.
Processing	The tool is working on it right now.
Needs review	Done, but some shots were missing or uncertain. Open the report and eyeball them.
Done	Done and clean. Nothing missing.
Error	Something went wrong (usually a missing Dropbox link or a storyboard that is not a real table). The report says what.

How the files get named

- A clip that matches a storyboard shot takes its name from the **Footage Name** column.
- Two clips that match the same shot get a version number: the name, then the name with `_v2`.
- Talking head takes are all kept and numbered: `take1`, `take2`, `take3`.

The POV rule (important)

The tool decides the POV label from the **actual footage**, not from the file name the creator used and not from the storyboard label (both are often wrong).

- **1stPOV**: the camera is on the object only. No person in the frame (at most their hands).
- **3rdPOV**: the talent is visible in the frame.

So a clip of a person smelling a towel becomes **3rdPOV**, and a clip of a styled bathroom with no one in it becomes **1stPOV**, even if the file name said otherwise.

Reading the report

1. **Renamed:** every clip that got a new name, and the scene it matched.
2. **Missing shots:** storyboard shots that no clip matched. These are the ones to check by hand.
3. **Needs review:** clips the tool was unsure about. It leaves these with their original name so you can place them yourself.

Good to know

- You do not run anything. Fill the row, click READY, and the tool checks for new jobs every two minutes.
- To run a job again, set the Status back to Queued, or click READY again.
- The `renamed` folder is rebuilt fresh on every run, so you always get the latest result.
- Always fill Client's Name and Creator Name. They name the output folder.
- The tool is a strong first pass, not a replacement for your eyes. The report tells you exactly what to double check.